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MILITARY STANDARD

DESIGNATION OF AIRCRAFT PROPULSION GAS TURBINE ENGINES

FSC 2840

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
Washington, D. C. 20301

Designation of Aircraft Propulsion Gas Turbine Engines

MIL-STD-879A

1. This Military Standard is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

2. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to the 4950th Test Wing, (4950/TZSA), Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio 45433.

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DESIGNATION OF AIRCRAFT PROPULSION GAS TURBINE ENGINES

1. SCOPE

1.1 This standard describes the method, assignment, and arrangement of letters and numerals used by the Military Services in establishing the type and model designation of aircraft propulsion gas turbine engines.

2. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS

2.1 The issue of the following document in effect on the date of invitation for bids form a part of this standard to the extent specified herein.

PUBLICATION

Air Force-Navy Aeronautical Bulletin

306 Engines, Aircraft Turbine and Jet, Designation of

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 New designations. A new engine designation will be assigned when, in the judgement of the assigning Service, any one of the following conditions is met:

(a) A need (either administrative or technical) exists for reference to, or definition of, a particular engine configuration or design which has not previously been assigned a designation. Normally, this will occur as a result of new engine development programs, or upon the initial entry into the Services inventory of off-the-shelf engines, and will involve a newly assigned type indicator.

(b) An engine configuration or design with an existing designation is so revised that interchangeability of the complete engine in an aircraft is affected, or there is a significant change in performance or installation, and the change is not made immediately retroactive to all engines of the same designation previously delivered. Ordinarily, this will involve the assignment of a new model number only. However, when the design change alters the engine fundamentally, a new type indicator may be assigned.

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(c) Design changes are made to an engine, with an existing designation, to the extent that a substantial number of parts or subassemblies (or both) are no longer interchangeable with the corresponding parts or subassemblies furnished in accordance with the approved parts list for the original model engine, but the changes do not affect the performance, installation, or interchangeability of the complete engine in an aircraft. Ordinarily, this will involve only the addition or change of the suffix letter in the model indicator, although change of the model number may be indicated if the quantity of parts affected is sufficiently large.

3.2 Special designation. The letters "X" and "Y" may be used at the discretion of the Services for the purpose of signifying development engines, as applicable. Generally, the prefix letter "X" will be used to denote an engine under development which has not reached the stage of successfully completing the official preliminary flight rating tests, and the prefix "Y" will be used to denote an engine still in the development category, but which has been cleared for limited flight use by successfully completing the preliminary flight rating tests. When used, such letters shall precede the designation arrangement described herein.

3.3 Designation. The complete engine designation shall consist of three parts: the type indicator, manufacturer's symbol, and the model indicator. A given engine design and configuration shall have only one designation for all Services. For example, should the Navy desire to use an engine bearing Air Force type and model numbers, the Navy will use those numbers without change for all designation purposes. Further, should the Army desire to use a Navy designated type engine, but require changes to the Navy model of that type, the Army will use the Navy type designation and assign its own model indicator to the modified engine.

3.3.1 Type indicator. The type indicator part of the engine designation shall consist of the appropriate type letter symbol selected from 3.3.1.1, together with a type number assigned in accordance with 3.3.1.2.

3.3.1.1 Type letter symbols. Type letter symbols shall conform to:

Letter symbols	Engine type
J	Turbojet
T	Turboshaft, Turboprop
F	Turbofan.

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3.3.1.2 Type numerals. The type numerals used in connection with the type letter will be assigned consecutively by the Services, and shall begin with the number 100 for the Air Force, the number 400 for the Navy, and the number 700 for the Army. The type numbers are arbitrary, and do not represent any characteristics of the units involved.

3.3.2 Manufacturer's symbols. The second part of the designation shall consist of a dash and a two-letter symbol indicating the manufacturer, as follows:

Manufacturer's Name	Letter Symbol
AiResearch Division, Garrett Corporation	GA
Allison Division, General Motors Corporation	AD
Continental Aviation and Engineering Corporation	CA
Curtiss-Wright Corporation	WA
General Electric Company	GE
Lycoming Division, Avco Corporation	LD
Pratt and Whitney Aircraft Division, United Aircraft Corporation	PW
Rolls Royce, Ltd.	RR
United Aircraft of Canada, Ltd.	CP
United Aircraft of West Virginia	WV
Williams Research Corporation	WR.

3.3.2.1 Special manufacturer's symbols. In special cases such as where two manufacturers are operating in a joint effort, a special manufacturer's symbol may be assigned which combines a letter of each of the two individual manufacturer's symbols. Engines produced by one of the two manufacturers shall use only that manufacturer's symbol.

3.3.2.2 Manufacturer's code symbols. These letter symbols are not to be confused with those codes established by the Federal Supply Code for Manufacturers, H4, which covers code identification symbols of principal manufacturers of equipment and parts.

3.3.3 Model indicator. The third part of the designation, the model indicator, shall consist of a dash and a model number, or a dash and a model number with a suffix letter.

3.3.3.1 Model number. The model number shall be assigned for a specific configuration of a given type engine. Air Force model numbers for each type of engine will begin with -100 and will continue with consecutive numbers. Navy model numbers for each type of engine will begin with -400 and will continue with consecutive numbers. Army model numbers for each type of engine will begin with -700 and will continue with consecutive numbers.

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3.3.3.2 Suffix letter. Suffix letters shall be assigned consecutively, starting with the letters A, B, C, etc., except for the letters I and O.

3.4 Mixed designations. An engine now designated with type indicator and manufacturer's symbol in accordance with Bulletin 306 will continue to use this type indicator and manufacturer's symbol for the remainder of its in-service life. When a new model number is required for this engine, the new model number will be assigned as described in this standard or, at the option of the issuing service, the initial model number in the new series shall consist of the last model number issued under Bulletin 306 added to the base starting number of the range assigned to the issuing service in 3.3.3.1. Thereafter, subsequent model designations will be assigned in consecutive order.

3.5 Assignment of engine designations. Each Service is responsible for the assignment of the engine designations within the applicable range of numbers specified herein (see 3.3.1.2 and 3.3.3.1). When a designation is assigned, the assigning Service shall notify the other two Services of this action and include a definitive description of the engine so designated. Notification letters shall be forwarded as follows:

US Army Aviation Systems Command
P. O. Box 209
Attn: AMSAV-ERP
St. Louis, Missouri 63166

Naval Air Systems Command
Attn: Propulsion Division
Washington, D. C. 20360

4950th Test Wing
Engineering Standards Division
Attn: 4950/TZD
Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio 45433

Custodians:
Army - AV
Navy - AS
Air Force - 11

Reviewers:
Air Force - 71, 82

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. *Fold on lines on reverse side*, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

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REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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